

Academic English 1 Group Presentation Assignment

Overview

For your only assignment this semester, you are to work with a small group to prepare and deliver an informative presentation of 8-10 minutes about a topic of your choosing related to life in Uzbekistan.

Purpose

The main goal of Academic English 1 is to improve learners' speaking and listening abilities. Earlier this year, you participated in a speaking exam in which you demonstrated your ability to have a conversation about theoretical concepts with your peers. Now, you will demonstrate your ability to plan and deliver a spoken presentation.

Process

Nov. 13 - 19	Group formation: By the end of this week, you are to inform me of who is in your group. Each group should have 3-4 people, no more and no less.
Nov. 20 - 26	Topic selection: By the end of this week, you are to inform me of your chosen topic. I may provide you with feedback to help you revise your topic if, for example, it is too broad, too narrow, too esoteric, etc.
Nov. 27 - Dec. 3	Materials preparation: By the end of this week, you are to send me the materials you intend to use in your presentation. This can include a slide show, poster, or other visual aids. Video and audio materials are not permitted! I may provide you with feedback to help you revise your presentation if, for example, some materials are unclear.
Dec. 4 - 10	Presentations: You and your group will deliver a presentation of 8-10 minutes to the class.

Assessment

You will receive a grade for this assignment out of a maximum of 16, based on the following criteria:

Grammar and vocabulary (1-4 points): You use vocabulary and grammatical forms appropriately, and you use a range of vocabulary and grammatical forms.

Pronunciation (1-4): Your speech is clearly understood and you appropriately use a range of pronunciation features.

Presentation skills (1-4 points): Your presentation is clear, compelling, and concise.

Materials: You create effective visual materials and use visual materials effectively.

A note on choosing a topic

I, Mr. Train, have been living in Uzbekistan for about two years, but there's so much I don't know about your country! As this is an informative presentation, I'd like you to teach me something new about one element of Uzbek life. Some possible ideas: Uzbek cuisine, Uzbek art, one chapter in Uzbek history, wildlife in Uzbekistan, or information about one city, town, or region in Uzbekistan. If you are stuck thinking up an idea, speak to me - I will help you develop one!

A note on academic honesty

Academic honesty is a core principle in every university. To preserve academic honesty, I will ask you to submit your presentations to Turnitin. Turnitin is a web service that detects similarity between texts; in other words, it will show me if your presentation is likely copied from another source.